# Category Policy Addendum: Home & Kitchen

KARTWAY OPERATIONS MANUAL
ADDENDUM 4.9: HOME & KITCHEN CATEGORY POLICY
Effective Date: 14 January 2026
Document Owner: Sarah Vance, Customer Operations Policy Lead
Applies To: All Tier 1, Tier 2, and Specialist Support Agents

**1.0 Purpose and Scope This addendum establishes category-specific handling rules, return parameters, and warranty enforcement standards for all transactions within the Kartway Home & Kitchen marketplace vertical. Where this document conflicts with the General Operations Baseline, the rules herein supersede.**

**2.0 Return Window 2.1 The return window for all Home & Kitchen merchandise is exactly 30 calendar days from the verified delivery date. 2.2 This duration matches the general Kartway returns baseline; no category-specific extensions, seasonal waivers, or reductions apply. 2.3 Return requests initiated on day 31 or later must be systematically rejected by support agents without exception.**

**3.0 Condition Requirements 3.1 To qualify for a refund, returned Home & Kitchen items must meet the following baseline conditions: * Cookware and Utensils: Must show zero signs of thermal exposure, heat tinting, or food residue. Items washed in a dishwasher that exhibit water spotting or detergent etching are classified as used and are ineligible for return. * Small Appliances (e.g., blenders, air fryers): Motor run-time must not exceed 14 minutes, verified via internal diagnostic logs where applicable. * Textiles (e.g., bedding, tablecloths): Must be free of pet hair, human dander, laundering odors, and synthetic fabric softeners.**

**4.0 Original Packaging Mandate 4.1 Original manufacturer packaging (inner box, styrofoam inserts, and carton sleeves) is mandatory for all small appliances, glassware, and ceramic dinnerware valued above $45.00 USD. 4.2 If an item under this value threshold is returned without original packaging, agents shall deduct a flat $7.50 USD repacking and containment fee from the refund total. 4.3 Items valued above $45.00 USD returned without original packaging shall be rejected at the dock and returned to the seller at the buyer's expense, unless accompanied by an approved pre-authorization code issued by a Tier 2 escalation lead.**

**5.0 Restocking Fees 5.1 A standard restocking fee of 12% of the item purchase price shall be applied to all opened large-format kitchen appliances (including espresso machines, stand mixers, and convection ovens). 5.2 Unopened items in factory-sealed cartons are exempt from restocking fees. 5.3 Defective or damaged-on-arrival (DOA) items are strictly exempt from all restocking fees**

**under operational code HK-DEF-09.**

**6.0 Hazardous and Perishable Handling Rules 6.1 Perishables: Food-grade items, culinary oils, and consumable meal kits listed under Home & Kitchen are non-returnable and non-refundable, regardless of whether the seal is intact, due to health code regulations. Agents must issue an immediate store credit for verified shipping damage rather than processing a physical return. 6.2 Hazardous Materials: Items containing pressurized gas cylinders (e.g., whipped cream dispensers, soda carbonators) or chemical descalers classified under hazardous transport codes must not be returned via standard postal drop-offs. Agents must issue a prepaid hazardous-class return label via regional carrier *Apex Freight* and apply a mandatory $15.00 USD hazardous processing surcharge to the merchant account ledger.**

**7.1 Manufacturer and Marketplace Warranty Period 7.1 The standard Kartway marketplace operational warranty for non-electronic Home & Kitchen goods is 180 calendar days from delivery. 7.2 Electrical small appliances carry a manufacturer-backed warranty of 365 calendar days, during which Kartway support agents must direct customers to authorized service centers before issuing marketplace-funded replacements or refunds.**